Oshkosh Leadership Traits

DEVELOPMENT GUIDE

OSHKOSH™

Table of contents

02 OVERVIEW

03 INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE
- Individual Contributors
- Leaders
- Leaders of Leaders

07 INSTILLS TRUST
- Individual Contributors
- Leaders
- Leaders of Leaders

11 FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT
- Individual Contributors
- Leaders
- Leaders of Leaders

15 CULTIVATES INNOVATION
- Individual Contributors
- Leaders
- Leaders of Leaders

19 CUSTOMER FOCUS
- Individual Contributors
- Leaders
- Leaders of Leaders

23 DRIVES RESULTS
- Individual Contributors
- Leaders
- Leaders of Leaders

27 RESOURCES
- Dev Plan Example
- Dev Plan Template
- Additional Resources

Development guide overview

What are leadership traits?

The Oshkosh Leadership Traits are how we achieve our work. They are measurable skills, behaviors and attitudes necessary to drive our success.

Our six traits were selected by over 40 Oshkosh team members as the essential skills and behaviors needed to achieve our North Star goals. The leadership traits work in tandem with our core values to prioritize a People First culture and enable our Innovate. Serve. Advance. business strategy.

Are they only for "leaders"?

No! One of the objectives of this guide is to break down the misconception that Leadership Traits are only relevant for people leaders. All team members can and should cultivate these traits, regardless of whether they lead a team. Each of us has the ability to lead and influence within the business.

How do I use this guide?

To illustrate the relevance of each trait for team members at all levels of the organization, we break each trait into three sections, each geared towards a targeted audience: individual contributors, leaders and leaders of leaders.

For each audience, we provide example behaviors as well as developmental activities to improve in each trait. Each chapter starts with a section relevant to all levels.

We hope this resource serves as a useful guide as you develop yourself and others.

Please share widely.

LEADERSHIP TRAITS

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

Painting a compelling picture of the vision and strategy that motivates others to action.

INSTILLS TRUST

Gaining the confidence and trust of others through honesty, integrity and authenticity.

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

Creating a climate where people are motivated to do their best to help the organization achieve its objectives.

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

Creating new and better ways for the organization to be successful, leveraging technology as an enabler.

CUSTOMER FOCUS

Building strong customer relationships and delivering customer-centric solutions.

DRIVES RESULTS

Consistently achieving results, even under tough circumstances.

Inspires vision and purpose

Painting a compelling picture of the vision and strategy that motivates others to action.

A common goal brings people together, especially during times of uncertainty and change. A sense of purpose unifies us and makes evident that our work matters. Team members are more engaged when they can connect their work to the bigger picture.

Do you know Oshkosh Corporation's purpose?

LEARNING FOR ALL LEVELS

LinkedIn Learning Link for Inspires Vision and Purpose

Korn Ferry List of Development Resources: Trait #37

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Individual contributor

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Struggles to explain the organization's vision and purpose.	Provides clear explanations of the organization's vision and purpose.	Delivers a compelling, energizing picture of the organization's vision and purpose.
Works at cross-purposes against the organization's vision or makes limited efforts to align with the workgroup's mission.	Takes steps to advance the organization's vision and ensures that own efforts align with the workgroup's mission.	Finds unique ways to contribute to the organization's vision and makes outstanding contributions to the workgroup's mission.
Conveys little sense of purpose when handling work tasks.	Operates with a clear sense of purpose that gives meaning to everyday activities.	Explicitly articulates the core purpose of his/her own work, and consistently acts in alignment with that.
Acts in ways that contradict or do not support the organization's vision.	Ensures clear connections between day-to-day actions and the organization's overall vision.	Finds novel ways to ensure that day-to-day actions advance the organization's vision.

On the job development

The following are ways individual contributors can develop these skills on the job:

- **Learn the company's vision and strategy.** Explore Oshkosh's mission, vision, strategic goals, values and sustainability report. Attend town halls to understand how company priorities align with these goals and values.
- **Connect your work to the big picture.** Link your goals, projects and deliverables to Oshkosh's overall direction. Understand how your efforts support the organization's vision and activate the strategy.
- **Understand the impact of your work.** Reflect on how your work contributes to the industry, society and your personal values. Why is it important to you?
- **Focus on your segment's purpose.** Clarify the purpose and vision of your segment, function and team.
- **Align new projects with team goals.** When starting new tasks, frame how your work aligns with the team's purpose and vision.
- **Leverage your strengths.** Reflect on your strengths, motivations and interests. If there's room to use them more in your tasks, discuss potential opportunities with your manager.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Misses opportunities to share the organization's vision or conveys the vision in a way that does not build energy or optimism.	Helps people understand where the organization is headed and works to foster enthusiasm toward this vision.	Serves as a strong champion for the organization's vision and regularly energizes people to commit to this long-term direction.
Explains the vision in a manner that is overly dry, general, unclear, or otherwise uninspiring.	Makes the vision real for others and encourages people to buy in.	Conveys the organization's vision in a highly compelling, persuasive, and inspiring manner.
Overlooks chances to highlight what is possible for the organization; may come across as too negative or too focused on the here and now.	Paints an engaging and illuminating picture of future possibilities for the team.	Captures others' imaginations with powerful messages about what is possible in the future.
Provides few messages about the difference that others' contributions make to the organization.	Gives people a clear understanding of how their efforts and contributions make a positive difference when the opportunities arise.	Regularly and enthusiastically indicates how people's efforts and contributions make a positive difference.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Engage in strategic planning.** Participate in planning sessions to gain insight into how the organization's vision is developed.
- **Lead vision-aligned projects.** Take ownership of projects that support your team's or organization's vision to practice turning strategy into action.
- **Mentor team members.** Help colleagues understand and connect their work to the broader vision.
- **Facilitate vision discussions.** Organize workshops or meetings to discuss and refine your team's vision.
- **Celebrate progress.** Set and recognize milestones that reflect movement toward the vision.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader of leaders

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Leaves the organization's positive impact unclear; may focus too much on the work to be done rather than the broader purpose behind these efforts.	Delivers compelling messages about the positive impact the organization can have on customers, the community, society, etc.	Speaks regularly about why the work they do is important to the world.
Makes few or ineffective efforts to clarify the organization's vision, mission, and values.	Provides clarity around the organization's vision, mission, and values.	Expresses the organization's vision, mission, and values in a compelling way that others can easily understand and remember.
Conveys limited energy and optimism toward the future or acts in ways that diminish the enthusiasm of others.	Instills a sense of energy and optimism throughout the organization.	Uses a variety of methods and communication techniques to build a feeling of energy, optimism, and motivation throughout the organization.
Shows only limited regard for the organization's purpose or vision; might give up on mission-critical endeavors quickly in the face of opposition or obstacles.	Maintains and expresses commitment to the organization's purpose and vision, even when situations become difficult or resistance is widespread.	Champions a clear purpose and vision persistently and uses this sense of mission to overcome resistance and hardships.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders of leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Craft a clear mission statement.** Ensure your team's mission aligns with the organization's vision using the framework: "Our mission is to _____ for _____ so that _____." Keep it concise and compelling.
- **Communicate with empathy.** Always explain the "why" behind your vision, considering the needs and motivations of your audience.
- **Align with stakeholders.** Hold discussions with key stakeholders to ensure your team's vision aligns with their interests and concerns.
- **Develop public speaking and storytelling skills.** Learn to effectively share the vision by tailoring your message to different audiences.
- **Build a vision-driven culture.** Foster a culture that embodies the vision through recognition, rewards and aligned practices.

Instills trust

Gaining the confidence and trust of others through honesty, integrity and authenticity.

Trust is the necessary foundation from which all other traits can grow and flourish. Being trustworthy means others can count on you, not only to deliver, but also to look after their best interests.

LEARNING FOR ALL LEVELS

LinkedIn Learning Link for Instills Trust

Korn Ferry List of Development Resources: Trait #36

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Individual contributor

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
May withhold or distort the truth at times; may be uncomfortable being direct or appear to have hidden motives.	Builds trust by maintaining an honest and straightforward approach with people.	Is consistently honest and straightforward when working with others; shares uncomfortable information in a clear and helpful manner.
Occasionally overcommits or doesn't follow through when dealing with competing priorities.	Instills trust by following through on agreements and commitments despite competing priorities.	Can be fully counted on to honor agreements and commitments while managing competing priorities; puts in extra time and effort when needed.
At times, actions do not match words; may not practice what he/she preaches.	Demonstrates consistency between what is said and what is done.	Is a trusted role model for team members, showing consistency between words and actions in various situations.
May overlook or ignore some standards or professional codes of conduct.	Demonstrates integrity, upholding professional codes of conduct.	Establishes a solid reputation for integrity by maintaining high ethical standards and professional codes of conduct.

On the job development

The following are ways individual contributors can develop these skills on the job:

- **Build strong relationships.** Get to know colleagues across teams, focusing on shared objectives and values.
- **Be reliable.** Build trust by responding promptly to calls and emails, delivering on promises and communicating delays to keep others informed.
- **Maintain confidentiality.** Always err on the side of discretion to protect trust.
- **Own your mistakes.** Admit when you're wrong and apologize sincerely. Demonstrating vulnerability and accountability strengthens trust.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Actions do not always match words; shows inconsistency in some situations.	Gains trust by showing consistency between what is said and what is done.	Aligns actions to words and stated values; is widely trusted to demonstrate consistency across a variety of leadership situations.
Occasionally overcommits or diminishes the trust of stakeholders when the team is unable to meet commitments.	Demonstrates reliability and places a strong emphasis on the team meeting its commitments.	Builds a team with an exemplary reputation for reliability and meeting even difficult commitments; puts in extra work when needed.
May show a lack of transparency regarding facts or motives or allow others to hide or distort the truth.	Is a model of honesty and authenticity and encourages others to be up front with each other.	Builds trust among people and groups by ensuring honest and up-front communication; takes steps to maintain transparency.
Does little to protect the interests of those not present; may not fairly or fully represent their concerns.	Fairly represents the interests of others and is trusted to speak up on their behalf.	Goes out of the way to fairly represent and protect the interests of those not present; is widely trusted to speak up for others' needs.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Know your team personally.** Understand each team member's perspective and consider it when making decisions.
- **Give credit where it's due.** Recognize and highlight individual contributions and specific actions taken by team members.
- **Bridge gaps between teams.** If trust is lacking, create opportunities for collaboration between teams to solve problems or work on cross-department initiatives.
- **Be transparent.** Share the reasoning behind your decisions to prevent misunderstandings and reduce uncertainty, which can lead to distrust.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader of leaders

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
At times, may place self-interests above the best interests of the organization and its stakeholders.	Places the organization's needs first, even when they conflict with self-interests.	Is widely trusted to place the needs and best interests of the organization above any self-interests.
Occasionally overcommits or diminishes the trust of stakeholders when the organization is unable to meet its commitments.	Demonstrates dependability and builds an organization with a reputation for living up to its commitments.	Creates an organization with an exemplary reputation for honoring agreements and meeting even highly challenging commitments.
At times, does not practice what is preached, diminishing trust and respect.	Gains others' trust and respect by showing consistency between what is said and what is done.	Is known to instill trust and gain respect by aligning actions to words and values; shows consistency across many leadership challenges.
May tolerate a lack of transparency or at times distort the truth, reducing the trust that others place in the organization.	Acts as a role model for honesty and transparency, promoting trust in the organization and its leadership.	Develops strong trust in the organization and its leadership through open and honest communication; takes steps to actively ensure transparency.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders of leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Prioritize team feedback.** Collect and represent bottom-up feedback, putting your team's needs first, with your own secondary.
- **Lead with ethics and consistency.** Maintain a strong personal code of ethics, be consistent in your actions and clearly communicate expectations. Provide feedback when behaviors don't align with expectations, so your team always knows where you stand.
- **Foster accountability.** Set clear, realistic expectations and hold teams accountable for meeting them.

Fosters engagement

Creating a climate where people are motivated to do their best to help the organization achieve its objectives.

Engaged team members have higher retention rates, are more productive and produce higher quality work. They feel appreciated, heard and supported. This may look different for each individual.

LEARNING FOR ALL LEVELS

LinkedIn Learning Link for Fosters Engagement

Korn Ferry List of Development Resources: Trait #16

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Individual contributor

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Gives limited attention or acknowledgement to others' successes.	Praises the successes of others.	Gives people targeted recognition for their achievements; seeks to learn from their successes.
Makes little effort to explain or emphasize the broader purpose behind tasks.	Shares insight into the purpose behind the work.	Ensures that people understand exactly why the work is important and meaningful.
Does too much on his/her own or takes all the credit, even though others have participated.	Involves others appropriately and gives them credit for their contributions.	Readily includes people and ensures that their efforts are recognized.
Holds the work and own motivations separate, without finding opportunities for overlap.	Recognizes how the work relates to own motivations; considers some ways to increase the overlap.	Demonstrates strong insight into how the work relates to own motivations; creative about aligning responsibilities with personal interests.

On the job development

The following are ways individual contributors can develop these skills on the job:

- **Get to know your colleagues.** Learn their names, interests and what motivates them.
- **Reflect on your own motivators.** Understand what drives you to perform your best, then communicate with your manager about adjustments to align your work with those motivators.
- **Take ownership.** Lead tasks and projects, proposing improvements and innovations within your scope.
- **Show appreciation.** Regularly reflect on and recognize your colleagues' contributions, using tools like Workday's "Give Feedback" feature to acknowledge their efforts.
- **Seek a mentor.** Find a mentor within the organization to guide you in engagement and leadership development.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Stays overly involved in decisions and work of the team; gives limited responsibility or ownership.	Ensures that others are able to make decisions and take accountability.	Trusts the team to make decisions and empowers them to make significant contributions.
Adopts an approach that is too task-focused, directive or independent to be motivating for team members.	Takes steps to understand people's motivations, engage them in their work, and build a sense of energy toward common goals.	Creates a highly motivating atmosphere in which many different people feel energized and enthusiastic about achieving common goals.
Overlooks chances to celebrate successes or acknowledge progress toward goals.	Finds ways to celebrate people's efforts, progress and everyday wins.	Regularly takes opportunities to celebrate efforts, progress and everyday wins so that people feel inspired to push ahead.
Creates or allows an environment in which people are not rewarded or do not receive adequate recognition for their successes.	Acknowledges others' accomplishments and ensures that people receive appropriate rewards for their efforts and successes.	Ensures that people receive visibility for their successes and finds multiple ways to ensure that efforts are rewarded.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Focus on team member development.** Have career conversations with your direct reports to understand their growth aspirations.
- **Highlight strengths in one-on-ones.** Use one-on-one meetings to discuss observed strengths and align tasks that match those abilities.
- **Use Peakon.** If managing five or more direct reports, review team results and respond to comments every other month.
- **Delegate with support.** Assign tasks with clear expectations, offering support and gradually increasing autonomy as appropriate.
- **Empower decision-making.** Allow team members to make decisions in their areas of expertise, providing guidance while encouraging flexibility.
- **Recognize achievements.** Offer recognition and encourage peer acknowledgment within the team.
- **Incorporate fun.** Plan off-site activities to foster team bonding and enjoyment.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader of leaders

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Creates compliance rather than true commitment, missing opportunities to appeal to the values and goals of others.	Generates commitment in others by appealing to their values and goals.	Fosters a strong sense of enthusiasm by skillfully connecting work activities with people's deeply held values and goals.
Puts little or no emphasis on the need to create and maintain a positive, high-morale workplace.	Takes some steps to create a climate that makes work gratifying and enjoyable for the majority of the employees.	Regularly identifies new and creative ways to improve the work environment and increase morale.
Misses opportunities to recognize others' contributions; may overemphasize own impact and downplay others' hard work.	Recognizes others for strong performance and valuable contributions; encourages others to do the same.	Creates an environment where people feel their contributions will be noticed and valued; expresses and encourages strong appreciation for people's efforts.
Misses opportunities to create a sense of purpose; may expect commitment without clarifying why goals should matter to others.	Provides clear messages about the purpose and importance behind the work.	Delivers inspiring messages that bring to life the broader meaning behind people's work.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders of leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Stay updated on leadership best practices.** Engage in industry forums, seminars and leadership programs to remain informed about trends and challenges.
- **Utilize Peakon results.** Review and share Peakon feedback, especially with leaders who may not have enough direct reports to see their own results, and respond to team member comments.
- **Empower decision-making.** Delegate authority to managers, allowing them to make decisions that align with organizational goals and encourage teams to own projects and initiatives.
- **Be transparent.** As a senior leader, it's your responsibility to communicate new policies, organizational changes and business results to your teams and leaders.

Cultivates innovation

Creating new and better ways for the organization to be successful, leveraging technology as an enabler.

To innovate, you must be comfortable taking risks. Innovation happens when the right teams are assembled, diverse viewpoints are heard and risk-taking is not only encouraged but celebrated.

LEARNING FOR ALL LEVELS

LinkedIn Learning Link for Cultivates Innovation

Korn Ferry List of Development Resources: Trait #19

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Individual contributor

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Offers fairly common ideas and solutions; suggests what's tried and true rather than creative.	Offers original ideas and innovative solutions.	Suggests creative and useful ideas; arrives at innovative solutions, often finding unique connections between previously unrelated elements.
Considers a limited number of mostly standard solutions, missing opportunities to explore new alternatives.	Considers a variety of alternatives and approaches to overcome barriers and find solutions.	Explores multiple approaches and experiments with a variety of alternatives to overcome barriers and generate innovative solutions.
Uses expertise in traditional ways; may be risk averse or uncomfortable trying new or unique approaches.	Approaches professional work in unique or innovative ways.	Finds unique and innovative ways to apply expertise at work; is energized by discovering and sharing new and better approaches.
Lacks openness to others' ideas and rarely encourages or strengthens their solutions.	Appreciates others' creative ideas and solutions and provides helpful input to enhance them.	Actively encourages and supports others' creativity; builds upon and strengthens new solutions in a positive and collaborative manner.

On the job development

The following are ways individual contributors can develop these skills on the job:

- **Never stop learning.** Stay current with industry trends and broaden your network by engaging in professional associations, attending workshops, enrolling in educational programs and connecting with colleagues. These activities expose you to fresh ideas, innovative technology and programs that foster creativity and workplace innovation.
- **Embrace change.** Innovation requires new approaches to tasks. Stay open to change by participating in new processes, events or professional activities. Remind yourself that change is positive, and adapting to new circumstances promotes growth.
- **Study innovative thinkers.** Identify five to 10 individuals who inspire you. Learn from their lives through biographies, documentaries or interviews to discover behaviors, traits and strategies that helped them overcome challenges and foster innovation.
- **Collaborate to solve challenges.** Host brainstorming sessions or work with leaders and colleagues to form teams dedicated to addressing workplace challenges.
- **Learn from mistakes.** View mistakes as opportunities to improve, adjusting as you move forward.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Provides insufficient resources for prototyping and experimentation, tending to stifle the development of promising ideas.	Provides support and resources for promising ideas through prototyping and experimentation.	Nurtures and invests in promising ideas by providing resources for development, prototyping and experimentation; takes risks needed to cultivate innovation.
Rarely requests breakthrough solutions; may prefer the status quo or be overly cautious.	Stretches the team to develop breakthrough solutions.	Rallies and inspires people to develop breakthrough solutions; is a leader of cutting-edge innovation.
Does little to promote cross-fertilization of ideas and perspectives during the innovation process.	Encourages people to incorporate varied perspectives to strengthen the innovation process.	Establishes systems that encourage and reward partnering with others during the process of innovation, ensuring that varied perspectives are included.
Misses opportunities to address challenges in new and better ways; may advocate taking a safe or conventional route.	Motivates others to find new and better ways to address challenges.	Models and encourages others to explore issues from a fresh perspective and tackle challenges in new and significantly better ways.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Enhance group creativity through diversity.** Teams with diverse backgrounds produce the most creative solutions. Gather people from various functions, levels and backgrounds. Use "open innovation" by gathering ideas from customers, suppliers and crowdsourcing to challenge ingrained thinking.
- **Question the status quo.** Set challenging goals that inspire commitment, encourage responsible risk-taking, and provide freedom for teams to work creatively. Learn from mistakes, champion innovative ideas and promote cross-functional experimentation and developmental assignments.
- **Disrupt "what is" with "what could be."** Disruptive innovations often transform industries by bringing greater access, simplicity and affordability. Look for niche opportunities that can evolve into game-changing solutions.
- **Ensure balanced participation.** Make sure everyone has a voice in meetings. If some individuals dominate while others remain quiet, encourage input from quieter members first to create balance.
- **Ask questions and embrace "yes, and..."** Foster creativity by asking, "What if? What else? Why not?" Use "yes, and..." to build on ideas in brainstorming sessions.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader of leaders

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Deploys limited resources to build an innovation portfolio and act on new opportunities.	Allocates resources to build a solid innovation portfolio and takes advantage of new opportunities.	Builds and maintains a robust innovation portfolio and invests resources wisely to discover and capitalize on new opportunities.
Does little to foster a culture that nurtures and rewards creativity and innovation; may not value or understand innovation.	Fosters a climate that supports and rewards creativity and innovation.	Consistently champions, nurtures and rewards creativity and innovation; builds an organization where innovation thrives.
Allows factors that stifle creativity and innovation to remain; is unaware of the barriers or decides not to address them.	Removes obstacles to creativity and innovation that exist in the organization.	Makes it a priority to identify and eliminate barriers and practices that hinder organizational creativity and innovation.
Places little priority on breakthrough innovation; may support the status quo or advocate playing it safe.	Leads the organization to develop and implement breakthrough ideas and solutions.	Directs and inspires people to generate and implement breakthrough ideas and solutions; takes smart risks to drive cutting-edge innovation.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders of leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Establish innovation metrics.** Apply the same rigor to tracking innovation initiatives as you would with other business projects.
- **Share innovation impact stories.** Highlight how innovation enhances customer satisfaction, team member engagement and brand reputation. Make innovation metrics visible and share them regularly.
- **Encourage responsible risk-taking.** Celebrate failures as valuable learning opportunities to foster a culture of continuous improvement.

Customer focus

Building strong customer relationships and delivering customer-centric solutions.

Some roles have a direct link to external customers, while others are more indirect or the customer you primarily serve may be inside the organization. Successful organizations are customer-oriented, responsive and consider the evolving needs of the customer.

LEARNING FOR ALL LEVELS

LinkedIn Learning Link for Customer Focus

Korn Ferry List of Development Resources: Trait #11

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Individual contributor

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Takes few steps to improve customer service; may rely too much on existing systems and approaches.	Investigates and applies some ways to improve customer service.	Regularly assesses customer service levels and identifies creative, viable ways to drive substantial improvement.
Misses opportunities to follow up to ensure that customer problems are solved.	Keeps in contact with customers and asks if problems have been resolved.	Maintains open channels of communication with customers; ensures that problems have been resolved to customers' full satisfaction.
Overlooks emerging customer needs and struggles to accommodate their new priorities or expectations.	Looks to the future and determines some emerging customer needs; determines appropriate responses.	Forecasts even subtle changes in customer priorities and expectations; makes regular efforts to adjust approach to ensure needs are always met.
Gives customer feedback little consideration and provides few ideas to meet future needs.	Studies customer feedback and uses it to determine some creative new ideas.	Digs deeply into customer feedback and drives the innovations that can enable the organization to better meet their future needs.

On the job development

The following are ways individual contributors can develop these skills on the job:

- **Anticipate customer needs.** Proactively communicate with customers by scheduling meetings, seeking feedback and guiding them through next steps.
- **Manage dissatisfaction.** Address performance or quality issues by troubleshooting problems with internal or external customers.
- **Reconnect with the customer.** Engage in customer-facing processes, ask for feedback during interactions, monitor social media for insights and keep the customer experience central to your work.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Takes few or ineffective steps to resolve gaps in the workgroup's ability to meet emerging customer needs.	Diagnoses gaps in the workgroup's ability to meet emerging customer needs and takes action to remedy these issues.	Stays attuned to emerging customer needs and ensures that gaps in workgroup's abilities are addressed before they become a problem.
Makes limited efforts to obtain customer feedback or data; may remain unaware of customers' views.	Solicits customer feedback and data; conveys a clear understanding of the level of service the team is providing.	Probes into customer feedback and data; uses this input to drive continuous improvement.
Misses opportunities to create a feeling of accountability toward the customer; may ignore complaints or handle too many customer issues on his/her own.	Delivers clear messages about providing a strong level of service to customers; takes action when team members do not meet standards.	Creates an environment in which team members feel a strong sense of ownership and accountability toward creating the best possible customer experience.
Creates or preserves business processes that do not align with those of customers.	Takes steps to align the business processes with those of customers.	Skillfully aligns and integrates organizational processes with those of customers, leading to substantial improvements in service.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Strategize customer service gaps.** Use data to identify emerging customer needs and develop actions to address them with your team.
- **Actively listen to feedback.** Purposefully gather customer feedback through various channels, quantify it and create actionable plans with your team.
- **Set and align customer service expectations.** Clearly define service expectations, align your actions and hold your team accountable through feedback conversations, addressing any issues as they arise.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader of leaders

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Places limited emphasis on the importance of providing excellent service; misses opportunities to build excitement or urgency toward meeting customer needs.	Speaks clearly about the importance of the customer; fosters a sense of urgency toward customer needs.	Champions the needs of customers; energizes people to provide outstanding service.
Provides limited or insufficient organizational resources and support to meet current or emerging customer needs.	Secures appropriate organizational resources and support to meet current customer needs.	Consistently ensures that resources are in place to deliver on both current and emerging customer needs.
Remains overly removed from key customers; seldom interacts with them regularly and shows limited awareness of their needs.	Creates and maintains effective partnerships with customers; identifies some ways to build and strengthen these relationships.	Builds and cultivates deep partnerships or alliances with many customers; creates new relationships, even while strengthening existing ones.
Misses opportunities to create a customer-focused environment; does not make customer satisfaction a high priority.	Supports efforts to build customer satisfaction, loyalty and commitment.	Fosters an environment where people are committed to maximizing customer satisfaction, loyalty and commitment.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders of leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Inspire buy-in through storytelling.** Engage your team in the customer experience by sharing stories, facilitating customer interactions and showcasing examples of excellent service.
- **Utilize organizational resources.** Ensure your team knows about available resources to meet evolving customer needs, and advocate for new resources when necessary.
- **Stay connected with customers.** Conduct regular check-ins with key customers, fostering an environment of active listening and engagement.

Drives results

Consistently achieving results, even under tough circumstances.

We persevere. Driving results requires an achievement mindset, a bias for action and an eagerness to take initiative.

LEARNING FOR ALL LEVELS

LinkedIn Learning Link for Drives Results

Korn Ferry List of Development Resources: Trait #28

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Individual contributor

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Shows a limited drive to achieve meaningful results; appears content with mediocre outcomes.	Conveys a desire to achieve meaningful results.	Is passionate about achieving excellent results and contributing significantly to organizational outcomes.
Does little to pursue or push initiatives/efforts to successful completion and closure.	Pursues initiatives/efforts to successful completion and closure.	Consistently drives initiatives/efforts to successful completion and closure in an extremely timely manner.
Gives up too quickly when situations become difficult; may be easily deterred from key goals by obstacles and setbacks.	Remains focused on achieving key goals, even in the face of obstacles and setbacks.	Demonstrates great tenacity to achieve results in the midst of obstacles and setbacks; continues to push ahead despite major challenges and frustrations.
Is satisfied with average performance; does not set sufficiently challenging goals for self.	Holds self to high standards of performance; sets some challenging goals.	Regularly pushes self to achieve outstanding outcomes; consistently establishes bold goals for own performance.

On the job development

The following are ways individual contributors can develop these skills on the job:

- **Break down objectives.** Divide larger goals into smaller, manageable tasks to make progress more visible and less overwhelming.
- **Prioritize effectively.** Create a system to prioritize tasks based on urgency and importance.
- **Track progress regularly.** Review progress against goals frequently, using tools like the Microsoft Teams' Planner app to stay organized with tasks and deadlines.
- **Manage stress and build resilience.** Use techniques like mindfulness and problem-solving exercises to handle setbacks effectively.
- **Collaborate on obstacles.** Communicate challenges to coworkers for collaborative troubleshooting rather than allowing them to derail progress.
- **Address procrastination.** If procrastination is an issue, start tasks early, divide them into thirds and regularly update others on your progress. Leave more time than you think it will take to finish.
- **Focus on priorities when overwhelmed.** Identify the mission-critical tasks and outline a few key steps for each. Allocate time for important but non-urgent tasks and then handle urgent matters.
- **Turn ideas into action.** Keep actions visible by posting reminders, creating timelines and sharing progress with others. Schedule time to move things forward — turning ideas into tangible results.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Places little emphasis on the need to achieve results; accepts poor outcomes or unproductive behaviors.	Emphasizes the importance of achieving results; challenges poor outcomes or unproductive behaviors.	Creates a results-focused team atmosphere; ensures that people engage in productive behaviors and don't settle for poor performance.
Allows people to become discouraged by setbacks or obstacles; does not help others move forward.	Helps others persist when setbacks or obstacles arrive; provides some assistance and encouragement.	Ensures that others push through setbacks and obstacles, creating a feeling of energy and an emphasis on excellence, even in very difficult times.
Misses opportunities to instill a sense of urgency for reaching goals and meeting deadlines.	Takes steps to promote urgency in others to reach goals and meet deadlines.	Builds a strong sense of urgency in the team for exceeding goals and beating deadlines.
Builds a track record for the team that includes too many disappointments and missed expectations.	Generally overcomes obstacles and delivers results through the team.	Consistently delivers excellent results through the team; establishes a superior track record.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Foster accountability.** Set clear expectations and regularly review progress with team members to ensure accountability.
- **Hold regular check-ins.** Schedule frequent meetings to keep team members on track for interim deliverables.
- **Invest in skill development.** Equip your team with the tools and training needed for success.
- **Provide guidance and feedback.** Support team members by helping them overcome obstacles, offering constructive feedback and recognizing their achievements. Follow the SBI method of providing feedback.
- **Delegate effectively.** If you're struggling to get work done through others, focus on delegation. Paint a clear picture of your expectations and let your team execute. Learn to let go and trust their abilities.
- **Set achievable goals.** Avoid setting unachievable goals, which can lead to discouragement. Establish goals that stretch the team, provide the necessary resources and set checkpoints to track progress. Celebrate successes along the way to keep morale high.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Leader of leaders

EXAMPLE BEHAVIORS		
Needs Improvement	**Meets Expectations**	**Exceeds Expectations**
Creates or contributes to an atmosphere in which too many people give up in the face of adversity.	Encourages the organization to push forward, even in difficult situations; provides reinforcement and support to help people overcome obstacles.	Fosters organization-wide enthusiasm to surmount obstacles; inspires people to achieve results, even when the path ahead is difficult.
Allows obstacles to organizational performance to remain in place.	Identifies and takes steps to eliminate the barriers and obstacles to organizational performance.	Forecasts, examines and skillfully addresses a wide variety of current and future obstacles to organizational performance.
Focuses inconsistently on delivering results that could have a clear and direct impact on organizational performance.	Seeks and obtains results that have a positive impact on business performance.	Achieves breakthrough results that have a clear, positive and direct impact on business performance.
Places a limited or inconsistent emphasis on achieving results; may be too theoretical, too narrowly focused or otherwise inattentive to organizational outcomes.	Urges the organization to focus on the topics that matter and act to achieve results.	Champions a results-focused culture; consistently focuses people on meaningful tasks and drives energetic action.

On the job development

The following are ways leaders of leaders can develop these skills on the job:

- **Develop and communicate a clear vision.** Break down long-term goals into actionable steps for each department to ensure clarity and alignment.
- **Foster a performance-driven culture.** Recognize high achievers and address underperformance swiftly to maintain a results-oriented environment.
- **Provide resources and support.** Ensure departments have the necessary resources to meet goals and address systemic obstacles that hinder performance.
- **Lead by example.** Demonstrate commitment, persistence and focus on achieving goals to inspire others.
- **Gain buy-in for results.** Slow down and include others in your thinking. Share the big picture, collaborate on plans and check in regularly. Address resistance by listening to objections, understanding concerns and making course corrections as needed.

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Development plan example

LEADERSHIP TRAIT	ORGANIZATIONAL ROLE
Customer focus	Individual contributor

SPECIFIC SKILL TO DEVELOP:	ACTIONS:	RESOURCES TO USE:	TRACKING PROGRESS:
Within the broader Leadership Trait, what is the specific skill I want to improve?	**What actions can I take to work towards this skill development?**	**Who or what can help me develop this skill?**	**How do I plan on measuring progress?**
Anticipating customer needs. While I have the interest and desire to serve the customer, I sometimes lack the foresight in anticipating what their needs might be to proactively address them before it becomes too late in the process.	▪ Read through previous project plans to see the evolution and the rationale behind reiterations. This can help me identify trends in customer requests to then use to plan ahead. ▪ Ask questions to the customer to get a better understanding of their concerns and objectives. If I orient myself around the big picture of the project, I can think of different alternatives to suggest to the customer that they might not be aware fits their needs.	▪ My manager can share resources from other projects happening on the team that I am not on so I can increase in awareness of project plans ▪ Sitting in on customer meetings to actively listen to customer needs/ concerns ▪ My manager sharing her anticipated thoughts	▪ If I can generate similar ideas as my manager ▪ If I can anticipate customer requests ▪ If I can foresee issues to bring to the customer

OVERVIEW

INSPIRES VISION AND PURPOSE

INSTILLS TRUST

FOSTERS ENGAGEMENT

CULTIVATES INNOVATION

CUSTOMER FOCUS

DRIVES RESULTS

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

Development plan template

The development plan template is fully interactive — simply select a leadership trait, choose an organizational role and add your responses to each question directly in the document.

LEADERSHIP TRAIT	ORGANIZATIONAL ROLE
Select Leadership Trait Inspiring vision and purpose Fosters engagement	Select Organizational Role Individual contributor Leader

SPECIFIC SKILL TO DEVELOP:	ACTIONS:	RESOURCES TO USE:	TRACKING PROGRESS:
Within the broader Leadership Trait, what is the specific skill I want to improve?	**What actions can I take to work towards this skill development?**	**Who or what can help me develop this skill?**	**How do I plan on measuring progress?**

Questions?

Our Learning and Development team is here to help. Whether you're looking for specific answers or want to connect directly with our team, you'll find the resources you need on our SharePoint site.

Learn how we can help

OSHKOSH™